

from \$15-\$25, a specialist is \$30-\$50, urgent care is \$75-\$100, and an emergency room visit can be \$200-\$300.⁶¹ Unfortunately, copays typically do not count toward your deductible.

In contrast, **coinsurance** is a percentage of covered medical expenses that you will need to pay in certain situations. While copays are a set amount of money that you pay for services, coinsurance is a percentage of the actual bill that you are responsible for. Coinsurance might apply once you have already paid your deductible, or if you visit a doctor outside of your network (as discussed later in this section). Like deductibles, your copay and coinsurance typically have an inverse relationship with your premium; the higher your premium, the lower your copays, coinsurance, and deductibles.

Let's say you need to get a \$10,000 surgery, you have a \$1,500 deductible that you have not met yet, and you have a 20% coinsurance on the operation. Figure 10.2 illustrates how the costs of the surgery will be divided between you and your insurance provider.

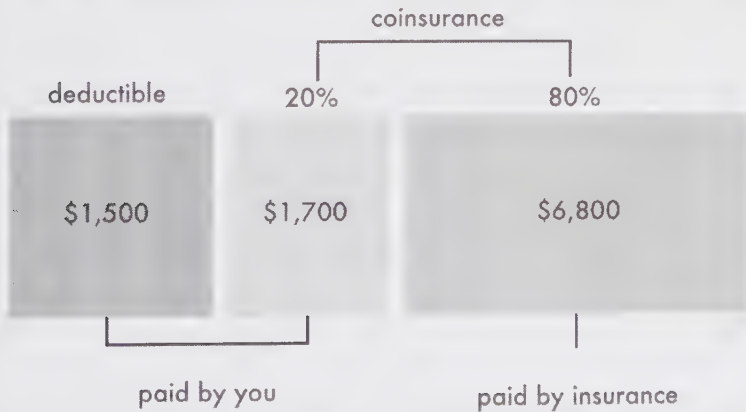


Figure 10.2. Paying for a \$10,000 surgery with insurance

⁶¹ Bill Fay, "Health Insurance Premiums, Deductibles, Copays and Coinsurance," Debt. org, accessed June 2020, <https://www.debt.org/medical/health-insurance-premiums>.